AHMED ESSAM

SOC ANALYST (L1)

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity-focused IT professional with 6+ years of enterprise IT support and network infrastructure experience, transitioning into SOC Analyst (L1) operations. Hands-on practical experience in alert triage, Windows Event Log analysis, network traffic analysis, and SIEM monitoring, built through structured labs and self-directed projects. Skilled in applying the MITRE ATT&CK framework, TCP/IP troubleshooting, Active Directory administration, and Python-based security automation. Seeking to bring strong troubleshooting discipline and a security-first mindset to a SOC team protecting enterprise environments.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Operations: SIEM Monitoring, Alert Triage, Incident Response, Log Analysis, MITRE ATT&CK, Windows Event Log Analysis, IOC Analysis, Threat Detection

SIEM Platforms: Splunk, IBM QRadar, Wazuh

Security Tools: Wireshark, Nmap, Burp Suite

Firewalls: Palo Alto Networks, Sophos, Fortinet

EDR: CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, VPN, MPLS, Firewalls, Routers, Switches, LAN/WAN, Packet Inspection

Systems: Windows Server, Active Directory, Linux, Windows Endpoints

Programming / Automation: Python (Security Automation), Bash, LangChain, Ollama (local LLM integration)

Certifications & Training: Cisco CCNA (Routing & Switching), TryHackMe SOC Level 1 Path

HANDS-ON EXPERIENCE – SPLUNK SIEM

- Performed alert triage and event investigation using Splunk SPL queries across firewall, endpoint, and authentication logs.
- Built correlation searches, dashboards, and alerts in Splunk to detect anomalous activity and support incident response workflows.
- Practiced log ingestion, field extraction, and data normalization in Splunk through hands-on labs (TryHackMe SOC Level 1 path).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IT Support & Security Operations **May 2020 – Present**

Proper Business Solutions | Cairo, Egypt

- Monitored firewall logs and events daily, investigating network connectivity and security incidents to identify and contain anomalous activity.
- Analyzed Windows endpoint logs to detect anomalies and troubleshoot security-related issues across the user environment.
- Diagnosed and resolved LAN/WAN, VPN, DNS, and firewall configuration issues, minimizing downtime and security exposure.
- Maintained system security compliance and managed end-to-end ticket-based incident response within SLA targets.

Enterprise Technical Support **Nov 2017 – May 2020**

WE (Telecom Egypt) | Cairo, Egypt

- Troubleshot enterprise VPN, MPLS, and leased-line connectivity issues for large business accounts.
- Performed network traffic analysis and packet inspection to isolate and resolve connectivity and security problems.
- Handled incident resolution and threat reporting through enterprise ticketing systems, ensuring accurate escalation and documentation.

CYBERSECURITY PROJECTS & PRACTICAL LABS

Autonomous SOC Security Agent — AI-Powered Log Analysis Tool **May 2026**

Python, LangChain, Ollama | GitHub Repository

- Developed an AI-assisted tool for parsing security logs and generating automated incident reports.
- Integrated LangChain with local LLMs to streamline threat analysis and recommendation workflows.

TryHackMe Cybersecurity Portfolio — SOC Level 1 Learning Path **Nov 2025 – Present**

Hands-on Security Labs | Portfolio

- Completed the SOC Level 1 learning path, covering practical labs in alert triage, log analysis, and incident response.
- Analyzed Windows Event Logs, mapped adversary behaviors using MITRE ATT&CK, and performed IOC analysis.
- Built Python automation scripts for security utility tasks and vulnerability discovery.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Communication Engineering **Aug 2012 – May 2017**

Misr Higher Institute for Engineering and Technology | Mansoura, Egypt

- Graduation Project: Implementation of Voice over IP (VoIP) using Cisco CUCM — Grade: Excellent.

LANGUAGES

Arabic — Native | English — Intermediate